

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 400

By Yarbro

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Gladys Maurine Chatman.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Gladys Maurine Chatman; and

WHEREAS, born on March 12, 1928, in Gleason to Edgar Lee and Ida McGehee, Gladys Chatman enjoyed a bucolic existence in Weakley County on a sweet potato farm with her five siblings, and although they did not have electricity until Mrs. Chatman was thirteen, their riches in familial love and agrarian simplicity were apparent and abundant; and

WHEREAS, due to her parents' strenuous efforts and educational emphasis, all six of their children, including Mrs. Chatman, were able to attend college and earn degrees; Mrs. Chatman graduated as the valedictorian of Gleason High School and went on to graduate from Bethel College and Middle Tennessee State University, where she met her beloved husband, Walter Chatman; and

WHEREAS, once the couple moved to Nashville, Mrs. Chatman became a school social worker, a job that suited her frank yet friendly demeanor, and in her decades-long tenure, she assisted countless middle and high school students in realizing their true potential and actuating their best self; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Chatman, ever athirst for knowledge, decided after her retirement to take Lifelong Learner courses through Vanderbilt University, and she always remained abreast of current events and active in politics; and

WHEREAS, not wishing to hide her lamp under a bushel, she began to give generously of her time as a volunteer for St. Thomas Hospital and Meals on Wheels, in addition to her work with Women's Club programs; and

WHEREAS, baptized in the Obion River at the age of twelve, Mrs. Chatman was not content to concern herself merely with this world but thought much of the next, and she was an active member of Nashville First Baptist Church, a faithful and loving soul to the last; and

WHEREAS, she is still fondly remembered by her nephew, Tony (Becki) McGehee; her great nieces, Meagan (Cason) Short and Rachel (Stan) Revelle; her great-nephew, David Kenney; her lifelong "family" members, John McCullough and Albert Marsh; and her godson, Guy Marsh; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her parents, she was preceded in death by her siblings, Annie Lee, JD, Leroy, Alberta, and Maddie Joyce, and her beloved niece, Catherine Kenney; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Chatman was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Gladys Maurine Chatman, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Chatman.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.